

Dangerous planet

The top, rocky layer of the Earth is made up of gigantic plates that float on a layer of hot rock. Where these plates meet, earthquakes and volcanoes are common.

Seismographs record the movement of the Earth.

Earthquake strength is measured using the Richter scale. Over eight on the scale is a very strong earthquake!

The point on the ground directly above the red dot is the epicentre. This is where the most damage occurs.

In places where earthquakes are common, buildings are designed to wobble but not collapse.

Earthquakes

When plates collide or scrape against each other, pressure builds up. After this pressure is released, shock waves travel through the ground. This is known as an earthquake and it can be very dangerous.

The red dot is called the hypocentre. This is where an earthquake begins.

Tsunamis

Earthquakes happen underwater, too. When they occur, it can cause water levels to rise and create gigantic waves called tsunamis. They travel at great speeds and can cause a lot of destruction.

